

Gothic Revival – Europe and America

Initially, the Gothic Revival was an English style, but by the second half of the 19th century it was appearing erratically in other parts of Europe and America. In 1879, Heinrich von Ferstel (1828–83) built the Votivkirche in Vienna, a national shrine to the Emperor Franz Joseph I (opposite). A unique interpretation of the 13th-century French Gothic style, it features two slender, soaring towers and lozenge-patterned tiling on the steeply pitched roof. Across the Atlantic, Richard Upjohn (1802–78) built Trinity Church in New York (1846), which features towering pointed arches, an 86-metre (281-ft) spire and jewel-bright stained-glass windows. Also in New York, the Woolworth Building on Broadway was designed by Cass Gilbert (1859–1934), with a modern steel skeleton and a strongly Gothic façade. Dominated by a massive central tower, the Woolworth Building (completed 1913) comprises 30 storeys, incorporating turrets, towers and lanterns with a copper-clad pitched roof. Because of its resemblance to European Gothic cathedrals, it was nicknamed ‘The Cathedral of Commerce’.

